

VERONICA

subsp. *teucrium* (syn. *V. teucrium*) illus. p.343. **subsp. *teucrium* ‘Kapitän’** illus. p.343. **subsp. *teucrium* ‘Royal Blue’** has deep royal-blue flowers.

V. beccabunga (Brooklime) illus. p.442.

V. cinerea. Spreading, much-branched, woody-based perennial. H 6in (15cm), S 1ft (30cm). Produces small, linear, occasionally ovate, hairy, silvery-white leaves. Trailing flower stems bear saucer-shaped, deep blue to purple flowers, with white eyes, in early summer. Suitable for a sunny rock garden. Z5–8

V. fruticans (Rock speedwell). Deciduous, upright to procumbent subshrub. H to 3in (8cm), S to 8in (20cm). Leaves are ovate and green. Spikes of saucer-shaped, bright blue flowers, each with a red eye, are produced in summer. Suitable for a rock garden. Z4–9

V. gentianoides illus. p.271.

V. incana. See *V. spicata* subsp. *incana*.

V. longifolia. Variable, upright perennial. H to 4ft (1.2m), S 1ft (30cm). In late summer and early fall, bears long, terminal racemes of star-shaped, lilac-blue flowers on stems with narrowly ovate to lance-shaped, toothed, mid-green leaves. Z4–8

V. pectinata. Dense, mat-forming perennial, sometimes semierect. H and S 8in (20cm). Has small, narrowly ovate, hairy leaves and bears loose sprays of saucer-shaped, soft blue to blue-violet flowers in summer. Good for a rock garden or bank. Z4–9. **‘Rosea’**, H 3in (8cm), has rose-lilac flowers.

V. peduncularis of gardens. See *V. umbrosa*.

V. perfoliata. See *Parahebe perfoliata*.

V. prostrata, syn. *V. rupestris*, (Prostrate speedwell), illus. p.343.

‘Spode Blue’ is a dense, mat-forming perennial. H to 1ft (30cm), S indefinite. Upright spikes of small, saucer-shaped, china-blue flowers are produced in early summer. Leaves are narrowly ovate and toothed. **‘Trehane’** illus. p.343. H5

V. rupestris. See *V. prostrata*.

V. spicata (Spiked speedwell). Clump-forming perennial. H 1–2ft (30–60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Spikes of small, star-shaped, bright blue flowers are borne in summer above narrowly ovate, toothed, mid-green leaves. (borderline) Z3–8. **subsp. *incana*** (syn. *V. incana*) illus. p.271. **‘Romiley Purple’** illus. p.239.

V. teucrium. See *V. austriaca* subsp. *teucrium*.

V. umbrosa, syn. *V. peduncularis* of gardens, illus. p.271. **‘Georgia Blue’**, is a vigorous, mat-forming perennial. H to 4in (10cm), S 2ft (60cm) or more. Ovate to lance-shaped, toothed leaves are glossy, purple-tinged, mid-green. In early spring–summer, bears racemes of saucer-shaped, deep blue flowers, with small white eyes. Easily grown and free-flowering. Z4–8

V. virginica. See *Veronicastrum virginicum*.

VERONICASTRUM

PLANTAGINACEAE/SCROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of perennials, grown for their elegant, pale blue flowers. Fully hardy. Requires a position in sun and moist soil. Propagate by division in spring or fall, by softwood or semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.

V. virginicum, syn. *Veronica virginica*. Upright perennial. H to 6ft (2m), S 1½ft (45cm). In late summer, racemes of small, star-shaped, purple-blue or pink flowers crown stems clothed with whorls of narrowly lance-shaped, dark green leaves. Z3–8. **f. *album*** has spires of small, white flowers in late summer, with pink-flushed bases and pink anthers, on stems clothed with whorls of narrow, dark green leaves. **‘Fascination’** illus. p.220.

VESALEA

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, summer-flowering shrubs, sometimes included in *Abelia* or *Linnaea*. Frost hardy to half hardy. Needs well-drained soil and a position in sun—preferably against a sunny wall in all but the mildest areas. Propagate by softwood or semiripe cuttings in summer.

V. floribunda, syn. *Abelia floribunda*. Evergreen, arching shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 12ft (4m). Has ovate, glossy, dark green leaves. In early summer, produces profuse clusters of pendent, tubular, bright cerise flowers, with 5-lobed, green calyces at the end of short shorts from the previous year’s growth. Z8–9

VESTIA

SOLANACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen shrub, grown for its attractive, but malodorous, flowers and foliage. Frost hardy, but in cold areas is best cut to ground level and grown against a south-facing wall. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.

V. foetida, syn. *V. lycioides*, illus. p.194.

V. lycioides. See *V. foetida*.

VIBURNUM

ADOXACEAE/CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of deciduous, semievergreen or evergreen shrubs, sometimes trees, grown for their foliage, fall color (in many deciduous species), flowers and, often, fruits. Fruiting is generally most prolific when several plants of different clones are planted together. Fully to frost hardy. Grow in sun or partial shade and in deep, fertile, not too dry soil. To thin out overgrown plants, cut out some older shoots after flowering. Propagate by cuttings (softwood for deciduous species, semiripe for evergreens) in summer or by seed in fall. ☉ The fruits of viburnums may cause mild stomach upset if ingested. See also feature panel p.142.

V. betulifolium illus. p.142. Deciduous, upright, arching shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Bright green leaves are slightly glossy beneath. Heads of small, white flowers in early summer are succeeded by profuse nodding clusters of decorative, bright red fruits in fall–winter. Z5–9

***V. x bodnantense* ‘Charles Lamont’**. Deciduous, upright shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 6ft (2m). Ovate, toothed, dark green leaves are bronze when young. Clusters of fragrant, tubular, bright pink flowers are borne from late fall to early spring. Z6–9. **‘Dawn’** illus. p.143.

‘Deben’ bears tubular, white flowers, tinted with pink.

V. x burkwoodii. Semievergreen, bushy, open shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Rounded heads of fragrant, tubular, pink, then white flowers are borne amid ovate, glossy, dark green leaves from mid- to late spring. Z4–8. **‘Anne Russell’**, H and S 5ft (1.5m), is deciduous and has very fragrant, white flowers. **‘Mohawk’** has very fragrant white flowers with red backs, that are bright red in bud, and glossy green leaves that turn orange-red in fall. **‘Park Farm Hybrid’** bears very fragrant, white flowers that are slightly pink in bud, and older leaves turn bright red in fall.

V. x carlcephalum illus. p.111.

V. carlesii illus. p.146. **‘Aurora’** is a deciduous, bushy, dense shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Broadly ovate leaves are bronze when young and turn purple-red in fall. From mid- to late spring, bears rounded heads of dark red buds, opening to pinkish white flowers. **‘Diana’** has red buds that open to very fragrant, tubular, pink flowers fading to white. Z4–7

V. cinnamomifolium. Evergreen, bushy or treelike shrub. H and S 15ft (5m). Large, ovate leaves, each have 3 prominent veins. Bears broad clusters of small, star-shaped, white flowers in early summer, then egg-shaped, blue fruits. Z7–9

V. davidii illus. p.165.

V. ‘Eskimo’. Mound-forming, compact, semievergreen shrub. H and S 5ft (1.5m). Produces ovate, leathery, glossy, dark green leaves. In mid- and late spring, pink-tinged cream buds open to tubular, pure white flowers. Z6–8

V. farreri, syn. *V. fragrans*, illus. p.143.

‘Candidissimum’ is a deciduous, upright shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 6ft (2m). Ovate, toothed, dark green leaves are pale green when young. Produces clusters of fragrant, tubular, pure white flowers in late fall and during mild periods in winter and early spring. Z5–8

V. fragrans. See *V. farreri*.

V. furcatum. Large, deciduous shrub. H and S 6–12ft (2–4m). Broadly ovate and irregularly toothed leaves turn red and purple in fall. In late spring or early summer, produces small, scented, white flowers, followed by red berries that turn purplish-black. Z5–9

***V. x globosum* ‘Jermyns Globe’** illus. p.120.

***V. x hillieri* ‘Winton’**. Upright, spreading, semievergreen shrub. H and S 10–12ft (3–4m). Has narrowly ovate leaves, flushed copper when young, with bronze-red winter color. In early summer, bears creamy white flowers, followed by small, ovate, red fruits, which turn deep maroon and black. Z5–8

V. x juddii illus. p.146.

V. lantana (Wayfaring tree). Vigorous, deciduous, upright shrub. H 15ft (5m), S 12ft (4m). Has broadly ovate, gray-green leaves that redden in fall, flattened heads of small, 5-lobed, white flowers in late spring and early summer, then egg-shaped, red fruits that ripen to black. Z4–7

V. lentago (Sheepberry). Vigorous, deciduous, upright shrub. H 12ft (4m), S 10ft (3m). Ovate, glossy, dark green leaves turn red and purple in fall. Flattened heads of scented, star-shaped, white

flowers in late spring–early summer, are followed by egg-shaped, blue-black fruits. Z2–8

V. mariesii. See *V. plicatum* f. *tomentosum* ‘Mariesii’.

V. odoratissimum (Sweet viburnum). Evergreen, bushy shrub. H and S 15ft (5m). Clusters of small, fragrant, star-shaped, white flowers, borne amid ovate, leathery, glossy, dark green leaves in late spring, are followed by egg-shaped, red fruits that ripen to black. Z8–10

V. opulus (Guelder rose). Vigorous, deciduous, bushy shrub. H and S 12ft (4m). Bears broadly ovate, lobed, deep green leaves that redden in fall and, in late spring and early summer, flattened, lace-caplike heads of white flowers. Produces large bunches of spherical, bright red fruits. Z3–8. **‘Compactum’** illus. p.162.

‘Roseum’ (syn. V.o. ‘Sterile’; Snowball tree), H and S to 12ft (4m), has a rounded habit, with leaves that become purple-tinted in fall. Bears large, white or green-tinted white flowers, which may turn pink.

‘Sterile’ see V.o. ‘Roseum’.

‘Xanthocarpum’ has yellow fruits and mid-green leaves that become yellow in fall.

V. plicatum (Japanese snowball tree). Deciduous, bushy, spreading shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 12ft (4m). Leaves are ovate, toothed, deeply veined, and dark green, turning reddish-purple in fall. Dense, rounded heads of large, sterile, flattish, white flowers are borne along branches in late spring and early summer. Z5–8.

f. *plicatum* ‘Nanum’ see V.p.

f. *tomentosum* ‘Nanum Semperflorens’.

f. *plicatum* ‘Popcorn’ is compact and early-flowering, bearing numerous creamy white flower heads. **f. *tomentosum*** has tiered branches, flattish, lacecaplike flower heads and red fruits, ripening to black.

f. *tomentosum* ‘Cascade’ is reliably free-fruited. **f. *tomentosum* ‘Mariesii’** (syn. *V. mariesii*) illus. p.110.

f. *tomentosum* ‘Nanum Semperflorens’ (syn. V.p. f. *plicatum* ‘Nanum’, V.p. f. *tomentosum* ‘Watanabe’, *V. semperflorens*), H 6ft (2m), S 5ft (1.5m), is a slow-growing, conical, dense shrub, with small flower heads from late spring to early fall. **f. *tomentosum* ‘Pink Beauty’** (illus. p.142) is a deciduous, bushy shrub, with dark green leaves, turning reddish-purple in fall. In late spring and early summer, bears white, later pink, blooms, followed by red, then black, fruits.

f. *tomentosum* ‘Watanabe’ see V.p. f. *tomentosum* ‘Nanum Semperflorens’.

V. x pragensae. See *V. ‘Pragensae’*.

V. ‘Pragensae’, syn. *V. x pragensae*, illus. p.131.

V. rhytidophyllum illus. p.112.

V. sargentii. Deciduous, bushy shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Maplelike, mid-green foliage often changes to yellow or red in fall. Broad, flattish, lace-caplike heads of white flowers in late spring are followed by spherical, bright red fruits. Z3–7.

‘Onondaga’, S 6ft (2m), has bronze-red, young leaves, becoming deep green, then bronze-red again in fall. Flower buds are pink.

V. semperflorens. See *V. plicatum* f. *tomentosum* ‘Nanum Semperflorens’.

V. sieboldii. Deciduous, rounded, dense shrub. H 12ft (4m), S 20ft (6m). Has large,